Lab 01: Premise, story spine and beat architecture

Course: Generative AI for Script Development and Storytelling · TGS-2025056983 · v2.0

Outcome: LO1: Use generative AI techniques to develop compelling script elements enriched with narrative structure and creative storytelling.

Build: premise contract, story spine and two beat-map variants.

Preparation

1. Open story-assets/story-brief.md. Record the intended audience effect, central conflict and duration constraint.

2. Open story-assets/character-cards.md and scene-slate.md. Fill only facts that are supported by your creative decisions; label unresolved items TBD.

3. Open both CSV ledgers. Confirm all names and events are fictional classroom material and do not substitute personal data or unlicensed media.

Detailed workflow

4. Start a new workspace or chat in a generative AI tool available to you. Paste the relevant role prompt from prompts.pdf and attach only this lab's files.

5. Ask the story architect for two controlled variants. Compare them using audience fit, causality, originality, feasibility and ethical risk. Record why you selected one.

6. Write three premise variants using protagonist, goal, obstacle, stakes and change fields.

7. Score each premise for causality, originality, audience fit and 90-second feasibility.

8. Turn the selected premise into both a three-act map and a five-beat map; reconcile their turning points.

9. Run the editor prompt. Copy each defect into a revision table, revise only the failed criteria and preserve the earlier version for comparison.

10. Run the reviewer prompt. Resolve or assign every bias, fact, rights, privacy, disclosure and accessibility finding. Update rights-ledger.csv for every generated or imported asset.

11. Act as the human creative director. Approve, revise or block the artifact; record the decision, creative rationale, version and date. Do not publish during class.

Acceptance checks

- Deliverable exists: premise contract, story spine and two beat-map variants.

- Every scene has an ID and produces a measurable change in knowledge, value or emotion.

- Continuity states are complete or explicitly TBD; generated assets have rights/provenance entries.

- At least one revision shows a before/after difference tied to a named criterion.

- Reviewer records PASS, REVISE or BLOCK and human creative approval is distinct.

Evidence to submit

Save the brief, prompt/output transcript, artifact versions, continuity and rights ledgers, review result and human decision in an evidence/ folder named for this lab. Include one screenshot of the final approved state.